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Answer Key – MG1MDCSOC100: Social Psychology

Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam
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Part A

1. Social influence refers to the way individuals change their attitudes or behavior due to others.

2. Self-esteem is an individual's overall evaluation of their own worth.

3. Discrimination is the unfair treatment of individuals based on group membership.

4. Person perception is the process of forming impressions about others.

5. An introvert is a person who is inward-oriented and prefers solitude or small groups.

6. Nonverbal communication includes gestures, facial expressions, posture, and eye contact.

7. Reciprocity in attraction means liking someone who also shows liking in return.

Part B

8. Case studies provide in-depth understanding of individual behavior and real-life situations. They are especially useful for studying rare or complex phenomena.

9. Mead explained that child-rearing practices shape personality through social interaction. Different cultures promote different personality traits based on social expectations.

10. Effective conflict resolution methods include communication, negotiation, compromise, and mediation. These methods help reduce tension and promote mutual understanding.

11. Interviews allow detailed and flexible data collection but are time-consuming. They may also suffer from interviewer bias.

12. Self-concept is influenced by family, peers, social comparison, and cultural environment. Life experiences also shape self-identity.

13. The psychoanalytic stages include oral, anal, and phallic stages of childhood development. Each stage is linked to specific personality formation outcomes.

Part C

14. A toxic relationship damages an individual’s self-worth through constant criticism, control, and emotional neglect. It creates insecurity, fear, and reduced confidence. Over time, the person may internalize negativity and lose emotional stability.

15. Self-disclosure involves sharing personal thoughts, emotions, and experiences with others. It strengthens emotional bonding and deepens interpersonal trust. Through honest communication, intimacy grows and relationships become more meaningful.